



Abarintos, Rob Cristan M.

3 – F1

SUCCESSFUL INDIVIDUAL FROM THE MIMAROPA REGION

IMMIGRANT

Marilou Diaz-Abaya (Filipino Filmmaker – with Mindoro roots)

- **Humble Beginnings:** Born in Quezon City in 1955, with family roots from Mindoro, she grew up in a well-educated family and pursued communication arts. Later, she studied film in the U.S. and London, exposing her to international filmmaking styles.
- **Early Struggles:** As a woman in a male-dominated industry, she initially faced skepticism about whether she could succeed as a serious director.
- **Breakthrough Victory:** She returned to the Philippines and directed socially relevant films such as Jose Rizal and Muro Ami, which received international acclaim and awards.
- **Sustained Success:** Her works bridged Filipino culture with global audiences, and she became a respected mentor to young filmmakers, proving that even those with provincial roots can shine globally.

BUSINESS OWNER

Editha C. Dacoco (Romblon Marble Entrepreneur)

- **Humble Beginnings:** Born and raised in Romblon, the “Marble Capital of the Philippines,” she saw the abundance of marble resources in her hometown.
- **Early Struggles:** She faced difficulties in competing with established companies, limited access to modern machinery, and challenges in marketing marble products outside the province.
- **Expansion & Innovation:** By organizing local artisans and teaching them quality standards, she successfully introduced marble crafts (sculptures, tiles, home decors) into regional and international markets.
- **National Success:** Her efforts not only provided jobs for locals but also put Romblon marble on the map as a world-class product, showing how a local business can thrive through creativity and persistence.



ARTIST

Ronnie Liang (Singer & Pilot – from Mindoro)

- **Cultural Roots:** Born on January 31, 1985, in Pampanga but raised in Mindoro, he discovered his passion for music while actively joining school contests and community events.
- **Family & Early Learning:** Coming from a modest family, he supported his studies by performing in amateur singing competitions before joining Pinoy Dream Academy in 2006.
- **Breakthrough Victory:** He gained national fame through the hit song 'Ngiti,' which became one of the most popular OPM songs of the 2000s, making him a household name.
- **Recognition & Legacy:** Aside from being a singer, he pursued aviation training and became a licensed pilot, proving his versatility and serving as an inspiration for Mindoreños who dream of excelling in multiple fields.